

In one line: VStack builds every child now; LazyVStack builds a row only as it nears the viewport (**no reuse**); List reuses platform cells but collects **all ids up front**. **ForEach** ids decide which state, animation and callbacks belong to which datum — and since iOS 17/18 the scroll view *reports* position, snapping, geometry and visibility declaratively.

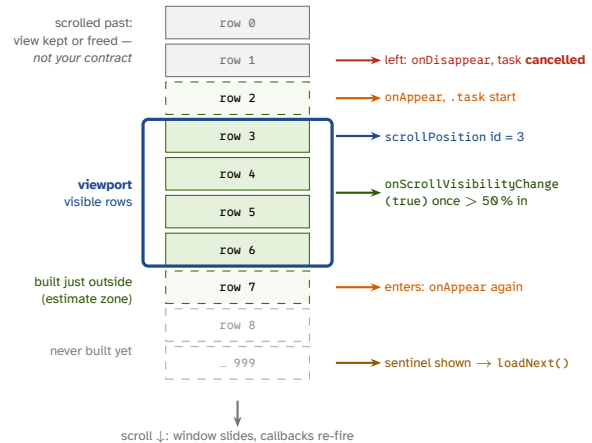
How it works

- **Creation:** VStack = exact layout, all children loaded at once. LazyV/HStack, LazyV/HGrid (14) create rows on demand; unseen rows' sizes are *estimated*. Apple: plain stack first, lazy when profiling says so.
- **List** visits the whole collection first: `rows = elements × views per element` (WWDC23). A variable count (if in `ForEach`) or `AnyView` forces it to **build every row** just to count them — filter the *data*, not the *views*.
- **Ids:** Identifiable or `id: \.key.id: \.self` hashes the whole value $\Rightarrow$ editing a field = new id = row destroyed + re-inserted. Indices shift on insert/delete $\Rightarrow$ state lands on the wrong row. Duplicate ids = undefined.
- **Row lifecycle:** `onAppear / .task` run when a row is shown; `onDisappear + task cancelled` when it leaves; **again on every scroll-back**. Keeping an off-screen row's `@State` is an implementation detail — durable row state lives in the model, keyed by id.
- **Position** (17): `.scrollPosition(id: $topID, anchor:)` — two-way: reads the top-most target's id, write it to scroll; **needs** `.scrollTargetLayout()` on the stack. 18: `ScrollPosition` value + `.scrollPosition($pos): scrollTo(id:), scrollTo(edge: .bottom), viewID(type:)`. Older: `ScrollViewReader`.
- **Snapping** (17): `.scrollTargetBehavior(.paging)` = container-sized pages; `.viewAligned = settle` on views of the `scrollTargetLayout`; or your own `ScrollTargetBehavior`.
- **Observing** (18): `onScrollGeometryChange(for:of:action:)` maps `ScrollGeometry` (`contentOffset, contentSize, contentInsets, containerSize, visibleRect`) to an `Equatable`; `action(old, new)` fires **only when that value changes**. `onScrollVisibilityChange(threshold: 0.5)` per view; `onScrollPhaseChange: idle / interacting / decelerating / animating`.
- **Look** (17): `contentMargins(_:_:for: .scrollContent | .scrollIndicators)` insets content inside the scroll area (still scrolls edge to edge); `scrollTransition { c, phase in }(.topLeading / .identity / .bottomTrailing)`; `visualEffect { c, proxy in }` — both return a `VisualEffect`: **no layout pass**, no `GeometryReader`.

Example — snapping, paged feed

```
ScrollView {
  LazyVStack(spacing: 8) {
    ForEach(feed.items) { item in // stable entity id
      Row(item: item)
      .onScrollVisibilityChange { seen in // 18, > 50 %
        if seen { log.impression(item.id) } }
    }
    if feed.hasMore { // sentinel row
      ProgressView()
      .task(id: feed.items.count) { await feed.loadNext() }
    }
  }
  .scrollTargetLayout() // rows = targets
}
.scrollPosition(id: $topID) // 17, read + write
.scrollTargetBehavior(.viewAligned)
.contentMargins(.horizontal, 16, for: .scrollContent)
.onScrollGeometryChange(for: Bool.self) { g in
  g.contentOffset.y > 800 ? action: { _, far in showTop = far }
}
```

The lazy window



created at first render, 1000 items, 7 visible:

VStack	1000
LazyVStack	≈ visible + margin; no reuse
List	cells reused; all 1000 ids read first

Traps

- ! `ForEach(items, id: \.self)` on editable structs, `UUID()` created in body, or indices — lost row state, wrong row animates, duplicate-id warnings.
- ! `if item.visible { Row }` inside a `List`'s `ForEach`, or `AnyView` rows — every row built to learn the count. Filter the array.
- ! `.onAppear { load() }` on rows = duplicate requests on scroll-back; guard `isLoading + cursor`, dedupe appended ids.
- ! Sentinel with plain `.task` may stay mounted after a page lands — no re-fire; `.task(id: items.count)`.
- ! `scrollPosition(id:)` without `scrollTargetLayout()` — binding never updates.
- ! A `GeometryReader` per row to read offsets — a layout pass each; use `onScrollGeometryChange / visualEffect`. `onScrollGeometryChange` watches the *first* scroll view only.
- ! `Transform` returns raw `contentOffset` $\Rightarrow$ action every frame; map to a `Bool / page`.

Remember

“Lazy builds late, List counts early; ask the scroll view, don't measure it.”